



The work of NGOs and donor funding; alignment with national land restoration strategies in Malawi

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Acronyms

CADECOM	Catholic Development Commission in Malawi	LDN	Land Degradation Neutrality
MNRECC	Ministry of Natural Resources, Environment and Climate Change	NCD	Non-communicable diseases
NFLRS	National Forest Landscape Restoration Strategy	NGO	Non-governmental organization
PERFORM	Protecting Ecosystems and Restoring Forests in Malawi	SDG	Sustainable Development Goal
WESM	Wildlife and Environmental Society of Malawi		

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Abstract

The misaligned work of NGOs and donors with the implementation of The National [Malawi] Forest Landscape Restoration Strategy (NFLRS) has a possible huge impact on attainment of SDG 15.3 –which aspires to achieve a land degradation-neutral world by 2030 –and its interaction with other goals. The NFLRS, whose implementation started around 2018, aims to achieve two major aspirations; the Malawi Vision 2020 and the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). There are observed misalignment in monitoring of realistic progress, lack of strong collaborative effort towards the sustainable management of Malawi’s environment, natural resources and climate change, and making adjustments and putting priorities right in landscape restoration. Using a multi-method qualitative research by conducting desk review, key informant interviews, administering of online questionnaire, the study analyzed how the work and interventions by NGOs and development partners working in the area of landscape restoration in particular, and environment and climate change in general, align with the NFLR strategy in Malawi. This is in addition to conducting an analysis of power asymmetric between development partners (donors), NGOs and the government; as well as tracking the presence –or absence- of SDG indicators in donor reporting or project evaluations. The analysis observes the existence of both synergies and trade-offs. The synergies observed in the analysis relate to SDG 12 (responsible consumption and production), other goals under SDG 15, and SDG 16. Trade-offs observed relate to SDG 1 (no poverty), SDG 2 (zero hunger), and SDG 16 (peace, justice and strong institutions). This interaction is attributed to misalignment among policies/legal instruments which has both accelerated and decelerated restoration effort, fear of project sustainability has amplified community voice in selecting restoration interventions, visible coordination and collaboration among stakeholders working in the same catchment area, and that monitoring on FLR lies on periodic country-wide survey and district plans.

Background

The Bonn Challenge, an international effort to restore 150 million hectares of land around the globe by 2020 and 350 million hectares by 2030 persuaded Malawi to make a commitment in 2016 to restore 4.5 million hectares of land. This commitment was made under both Bonn Challenge (ELTI, 2018) and the African Forest Landscape Restoration Initiative (AFR100) –a partnership of 34 member countries in Africa working together to restore 100 million hectares of land around Africa by 2030 (Karch, et al, 2023). In Malawi non-governmental organizations (NGOs) and development partners have been at the center of implementing landscape restoration interventions.

Development partners and Non-governmental organizations (NGOs) working in the area of Environment, Lands and Natural Resources, which make up 7 percent of all active NGOs in Malawi (NGORA, 2023) are highlighted as crucial partners in the implementation of Malawi National Forest Landscape Restoration Strategy of 2017. Except for the restoration intervention type of Community Forests and Woodlots, the Strategy emphasizes the role of NGOs in the rest of the interventions, thus; agricultural technology, natural forest management, soil and water conservation, and river- and stream-bank restoration (NFLRS, 2017). The National Forest Landscape Restoration Strategy (NFLRS), whose implementation started around 2018, aims to achieve two major aspirations; the Malawi Vision 2020 and the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). Precisely, the NFLRS sought to achieve at least 10% tree cover on 50% of cropland in Malawi by 2020 and 80% of cropland by 2030; increase area of community forests and woodlots to 200,000 ha by 2020 and 600,000 ha by 2030; improve protection and management of 2 million ha of natural forest, restore 500,000 ha of degraded forest, and establish 100,000 ha of commercial plantations by 2030; apply soil and water conservation measures on 250,000 ha by 2020 and 500,000 ha by 2030; and regenerate or plant 20 million trees along river- and stream banks by 2020 and 50 million trees by 2030 (NFLRS, 2017).

Intervention type	Vision 2020	2030: SDGs
Achieve at least 10% tree cover on 50% of cropland in Malawi by 2020 and 80% of cropland by 2030	50%	80%
Increase area of community forests and woodlots to 200,000 ha by 2020 and 600,000 ha by 2030	200,000	600,000
Improve protection and management of 2 million ha of natural forest, restore 500,000 ha of degraded forest, and establish 100,000 ha of commercial plantations by 2030		2 million Ha; 500,000 Ha; 100,000 Ha
Apply soil and water conservation measures on 250,000 ha by 2020 and 500,000 ha by 2030	250,000 Ha	500,000 Ha
Regenerate or plant 20 million trees along river- and stream banks by 2020 and 50 million trees by 2030	20 million	50 million

Source: Adopted from National Forest Landscape Restoration Strategy 2017

During a stakeholders engagement meeting between Government of Malawi through the Ministry of Natural Resources, Environment and Climate Change (MNRECC), Head of Missions, NGOs/CSOs and development partners funding work in the thematic area of environment and climate change, in March 2025, the Minister of Natural Resources, Environment and Climate Change decried the misalignment of NGOs and development partners' work towards the attainment of aspirations as stipulated in the NFLRS and other landscape restoration strategies. The minister's concerns revolved around monitoring of realistic progress, lack of strong collaborative effort towards the sustainable management of Malawi's environment, natural resources and climate change, and making adjustments and putting priorities right (Kaimira, 2025, Simutowe, 2025), that is attributed to the sluggish pace in the attainment of SDG 15.3. Particularly, the SDG aspires to achieve a land degradation-neutral world by 2030. Such perceived policy and invention implementation misalignments have been a general concern among project beneficiaries, local leaders, government and other funders of land restoration projects.

This study is very important for a number of reasons. Firstly, the study is expected to increase localization of land restoration projects to give more voice to locals to decide the design of the projects. Localization will enable projects to directly respond to the needs and demands of the communities receiving the intervention, and the nation at large. Secondly, there will be a well-informed stakeholder in the effective implementation of the land restoration projects. A well-informed stakeholder will increase project implementation efficiency towards the attainment of SDG 15.3 specifically, and other goals under SDG 15 in general. Thirdly, there is expected to be improved coordination in the implementation of land restoration work among donors, NGOs, the corporate sponsors and the government.

This will be achieved by identifying coordination gaps that might have exacerbated misalignment in efforts invested by these actors. Lastly, there is expected to be improved state- and donor-confidence resulting from efficient use of financial and non-financial resources due to improved alignment between donor support and country strategy.

Literature Review

The available literature related to the study area has tilted towards landscape restoration, SDG synergies at global and regional level, with sketchy literature related to Malawi pertaining the link between sustainable development goals and landscape restoration strategies. The study therefore reviews literature on SDG synergies at global and African level, landscape restoration initiatives and strategies applied in the Malawian context.

A scientific study by De Neve & Sachs (2020) analyzed varying relationships the 17 SDGs have with well-being, as well as how these relationships play out by region. The study which analyzed data from Gallup Poll, with nationally representative samples for the years 2016-2018 from 160 countries, found that there are increasing marginal returns to sustainable development in terms of human well-being. Specifically, the study findings show that two of the environmental goals, Goal 12 (responsible consumption) and Goal 13 (climate action) are significantly negatively correlated with subjective well-being. The study by De Neve & Sachs provides a strong springboard upon which my study builds. The global analysis with an overview of all 17 sustainable development goals gives a general perspective of how SDGs interacts with human well-being. This general global perspective falls short of narrowing down to how the work and conduct of specific actors such as NGOs and donors affect landscape restoration effort. In their analyses on environmental goals, the analyses excluded SDG 15 and focused much on SDGs 12 and 13. This study builds the gap left by the De Neve & Sachs research by specifically focusing on SDG15.3 and SDG 15 in general.

A study that sought to assess the implementation degree of SDGs in EU countries, and subsequently examined the interactions between goals confirmed the results obtained by many researchers regarding the more potent synergy between SDGs compared to trade-offs (Kuc-Czarneka, M et al, 2023). The study observed that in EU, synergies among SDGs are more common than trade-offs. The only trade-offs observe relate to SDG 15, which negatively correlated with SDG 3 and 17. In EU countries, the highest association is observed with SDG 5 – gender equality. In a seemingly unexpected outcome, SDG 7 did not associate with all other SDGs. This study, which studied European countries, has a different context as opposed to African countries which is the geographical focus of my study. In addition to continental differences, Malawi is categorized among the poorest countries in the world, making it difficult to infer EU research findings to local Malawian context, thereby necessitating a standalone study that reflects well with Africa and poorest African countries. Furthermore, while the EU study focused on general interaction among SDGs, my study focus on how SDG 15.3 interacts with others by bringing into the picture the work and conduct of NGOs and how it aligns with the national landscape restoration strategy.

Previous studies reveals a tendency by farmers in Malawian communities to engage less in restoring collective resources in protected lands and more in community-owned collective resources such as community woodlots and forests (Djerontin, et al:2022). A sense of affiliation to community-owned collective resources gives local farmers a sense of ownership thereby making them feel obligated to increase effort in restoring such areas. This reflects easier access into such collective resources which is mostly on customary land. For example, as a majority of community members living adjacent to a forest reserve in Ntchisi district are implementing SLM practices on their farmland outside the protected area, less than half the number of the same community members has participated in the implementation of SLM practices within the protected area (TMG, 2023).

The reviewed literature does not give conclusive findings on how land tenure security for smallholder farmers impacts landscape restoration strategies and initiatives. A study that sought to identify the impacts of land degradation neutrality (LDN) measures on the forest tenure rights of local communities living adjacent to Ntchisi Forest Reserve and Nkhotakota Wildlife Reserve in Malawi, cautions that much as investments in the institutional framework of LDN implementation presents an opportunity to enhance recognition of legitimate tenure rights, this should also ensure that LDN is not achieved at the expense of communities' livelihoods (TMG, 2023).

The intersection of gender equity and equality with landscape restoration has been a matter of policy and a research topic globally. Prior to the implementation of the PERFORM [Protecting Ecosystems and Restoring Forests in Malawi] Project in communities surrounding Perekezi Forest Reserve and Ntchisi Forest Reserve in Mzimba and Ntchisi districts respectively, findings of a preliminary study to assess gender aspects that could be relevant to the project show that both men and women benefit from these forests with resources for home consumption as well as for income generation. These benefits, among others, are in form of firewood, mushroom collection, wild fruits and charcoal production. Despite portraying insignificant differences in terms of resource benefits between men and women, huge variations are found in agricultural production per hectare as plots managed by women produce 25 percent less per hectare on average compared to plot managed by men (USAID, 2015). This analysis clearly points to the interaction of landscape restoration initiatives with gender equity and equality, one of the 17 sustainable development goals. As opposed to the restoration-gender nexus analysis based on two districts only, this paper reviews secondary data on the entire country and further conducts interview in one of the disaster-prone districts in northern Malawi.

Lastly, some studies that were conducted as part of the process of developing a framework for monitoring the progress of implementing the Malawi National Landscape Restoration Strategy identified inconsistencies in indicators and metrics used to track the restoration progress among districts. As a matter of procedure, NGOs are expected to sign a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the local councils in their respective work areas and submit monitoring and evaluation reports, this had not been the case. The lack of uniformity in adoption of restoration indicators is also visible among districts. For example, while Machinga district's Department of Forestry adopted three indicators, its Ntcheu counterpart chose seven indicators (GoM, 2017). The analysis in this paper has been conducted few years subsequent to these findings. My paper avails an opportunity to conduct an assessment of the state of progress the country has made in maintaining uniformity in monitoring landscape restoration initiatives at national level. The paper further analyzes how such uniformity –or lack of it- affects attainment and interaction between SDGs.

Furthermore, the literature on Malawi landscape restoration fails to neatly bring together the National Landscape Restoration Strategy, SDG interactions, and the work of non-governmental organization and donors. This is the gap my research seeks to close by conducting an analysis that looks at the how the work of NGOs/donors affect the implementation of the National [Malawi] Landscape Restoration Strategy of 2017.

Study Objectives

This study therefore sought to analyze how donor-funded projects support or bypass national SDG implementation frameworks and monitoring systems. The study analyzed how the work and interventions by NGOs and development partners working in the area of landscape restoration in particular, and environment and climate change in general, aligns with the implementation of the National Forest Landscape Restoration Strategy and other related national strategies in Malawi.

To effectively identify lapses in coordination, the study conducted an analysis of power asymmetric between development partners (donors), NGOs and the government. Specifically, the analysis identified gaps in how information flows between actors, and explored how the absence of proper coordination provides a fertile ground for duplicating efforts and/or failing to scale up successful landscape restoration interventions by development partners.

The NFLS is not open on who is responsible for monitoring the progress of implementing interventions in the Strategy. Regardless of this lack of clarity, the study further tracked the presence –or absence- of SDG indicators in donor reporting or project evaluations.

Methodology

This is multi-method qualitative research. To enable effective gathering of data, the study adopted a number of data collection methods.

Mapping of study participants

The study conducted a mapping of NGOs, donors and government officials. Mapping started with defining the scope of the study. The study was conducted at national level, i.e. it covered the entire Malawi. For online questionnaire, mapping narrowed down the focus to organizations implementing environmental interventions. To effortlessly reach these organizations, the researcher utilized WhatsApp groups for organizations and individual working in the area of environment. The researcher shared a questionnaire link on the WESM [Wildlife and Environmental Society of Malawi] WhatsApp group; a society of individuals and organizations working in the area of environment, wildlife and waste management.

Regarding face-to-face key informant interviews, the research sought to identify one of the disaster-prone districts in northern Malawi; Karonga. In Karonga, the study targeted one top government official working in the forestry department at Karonga District Council, and two NGO officials implementing landscape restoration intervention on a larger scale. The study also intended to conduct focus group discussions with project participants in the catchment areas of the interviewed organizations. However, due to other circumstances, the researcher was unable to access and travel to the catchment areas to conduct focus group discussions with project participants.

Government officials at central government level were mapped through the Ministry of Natural Resources, Environment and Climate Change (MNRECC). Initially, the [then] Minister of Natural Resources, Environment and Climate Change was among the officials that had the questionnaire sent to them. Unfortunately, the study only managed to get responses from one central government official working in the Department of climate change and Meteorological Services in the same ministry.

Data collection

Firstly, the study profiled donors that are funding landscaping projects in Malawi and their respective grantees. Through desk-based research, the study analyzed secondary data by reviewing 82 articles, financial and project reports of both donors and grantees to identify areas of alignment and misalignment with country strategy as well as SDGs in the four mentioned areas. These reports have been accessed online.

Secondly, the study conducted key informant interviews with District Forestry Officer at Karonga District Council representing governing officials at district level and also with two officials at CADECOM of Karonga Dioces, representing leaders of NGOs implementing landscape restoration projects at community level. Karonga district was selected for field data collection considering its vulnerability to climatic disasters and ongoing restoration work in the district. The study strived to highlight areas of convergence and divergence by mapping funding flows against national restoration priorities.

Furthermore, the study sought to capture the national perspective on alignment of NGO projects with the NFLRS. In this regard questionnaires were administered in Google forms by email to the profiled donors to respond to certain questions regarding country strategy alignment or misalignment of their support towards local and international NGOs on land restoration and environmental protection.

Similar questionnaire had been sent to NGOs and government officials at central government. Only one government official from Department of Climate Change and Meteorological Services, in the Ministry of Natural Resources, Environment and Climate Change responded to the questionnaire.

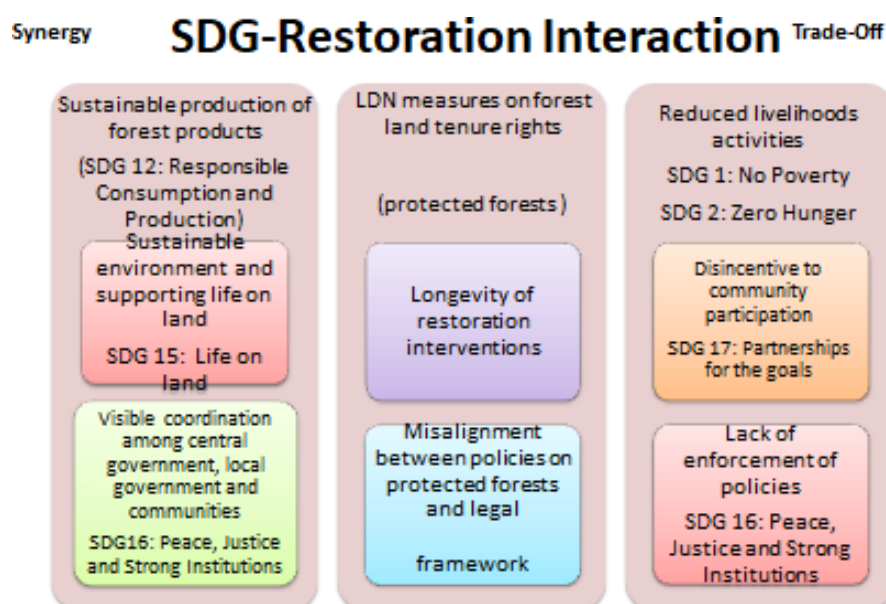
The great part of the analyses had been informed by desk-based research. The study reviewed 82 articles, financial reports, project reports and previous studies in land restoration, SDG interaction and general sustainable development.

Data processing and analysis

The data collected was highly qualitative. This data was processed through transcriptions with minimal requirement for translation to English. The transcribed data was analyzed using the Qualitative-Content analysis method.

Findings

The analysis observes the existence of both synergies and trade-offs. The synergies observed in the analysis relate to SDG 12 (responsible consumption and production), other goals under SDG 15, and SDG 16 (peace, justice and strong institutions). Trade-offs observed relate to SDG 1 (no poverty), SDG 2 (zero hunger), and SDG 16 (peace, justice and strong institutions).



Source: Author's analysis

The interaction between SDG 15.3 and other SDGs is articulated in terms of four forms of interaction observed by this study. These forms are; that misalignment among policies/legal instruments has both accelerated and decelerated restoration effort; fear of project sustainability has amplified community voice in selecting restoration interventions; there is visible coordination and collaboration among stakeholders working in the same catchment area; and monitoring on FLR lies on periodic country-wide survey and district plans.

Misalignment among policies/legal instruments has both accelerated and decelerated restoration effort

By its spirit, the National Forest Landscape Restoration Strategy of 2017 seeks to contribute to national restoration goals. The Strategy priorities seven specific goals by regarding them as national priorities. These are; improving food security, increasing energy resources, increasing climate resilience, improving water quality and supply, conserving and restoring diversity, ensuring gender equity and equality, and alleviating poverty (GoM, 2017).

Deductively, attainment of priorities in the NFLS translates to the attainment of some of the SDGs. The following SDGs correspond to the priorities in the NFLS: Zero Hunger, Gender Equality, Clean water and Sanitation, Climate Change, Life on Land, and No Poverty. This overlap would imply that intensifying interventions in the NFLS would catalyze the attainment of the listed SDGs in Malawi.

Restoration interventions are not implemented as standalone projects. Interviews with both NGO and local government officials hold that the longevity nature of restoration interventions is a disincentive to community participants as fruits from such projects take time to be enjoyed. This has made NGOs consider designing of restoration projects to include immediate benefits as communities await the longer term benefits. Despite tree planting gaining national visibility especially during the tree planting season, the study has shown that communities and government mostly prefer soil and water conservation projects. Within the NGO work, soil and water conservation has assumed names like Climate Smart Agriculture, Climate Justice, and Community Transformation among other names. Integration of restoration intervention with other interventions has been a catalyst for achieving multiple SDGs, mostly increased food production, sustainable energy, income generation through public works, clean and sustainable water, and sustainable communities.

Synergies among SDGs are common between restoration interventions and agricultural productivity. The mostly mentioned SDG interaction is the link between tree planting, environment conservation and food production, i.e. modern agricultural technologies and conservation technologies leads to increased food production.

In rare cases, deliberate project designs have enabled SDG interactions beyond food security and sustainable energy. One official at CADECOM mentions a unique scenario in a project he was involved in before joining the organization in Neno district located in southern Malawi, in which restoration interventions had been interacted with health outcomes. As part of helping people suffering from non-communicable diseases (NCDs), the implemented project integrated nutrition, tree planting and NCD awareness and lessons. The respondent describes the project as follows:

“The livelihood improvement project was implemented in Neno because people have more NCDs than any other districts in Malawi. Neno has 14 health centers and each group was formed attached to these centers. Also it’s one district that is underdeveloped and the project had NCD members and non NCD members and the issue of land was implemented by forming groups which were then made into cooperatives, and since the project had an aspect of planting trees, farmers were given a demo site for planting trees and were also encouraged to plant trees at household level. The project was looking at health centers where the groups were being used to teach health issues, nutrition so as to improve the health of the people with NCDs and the farmers were given, and these places were being used as demo sites”.

Despite the synergies among SDGs, a local government official at Karonga District Council bemoaned misalignment between legal instruments/policies governing the protection of forest resources. She faulted the courts for being soft on people that have been convicted for trafficking and destroying of forest resources. Similar sentiments are shared by NGO official at CADECOM,

“...we have policies that do not support each other. The environmental policy is trying to replace trees in areas where there are no trees, yet the energy policy has not enough measures to prevent people from cutting down trees and provide them with better energy sources. If for example someone uses gas in the rural area there are no refill stations which makes it hard for them to have access to clean energy, so still the consumption of energy from firewood is still high which undermines the number of trees that we are trying to plant.”

This has been considered one of the contributing factor to massive deforestation and general destruction of forest resources both in protected areas and community-owned forests.

Fear of project sustainability has amplified community voice in selecting restoration interventions

The study shows that the National Forest Landscape Strategy of 2017 exists only on paper, at least for the respondents interviewed in this study. There is seemingly little-to-no knowledge about the existence and content of the NFLS. A respondent from a government agency only remembers having been invited to a workshop on NFLS but could not remember what it is all about. The expression of ignorance of the NFLS among government and NGO officials could be a sign that the situation is even worse at community level. Ironically, responses across key informants point to communities as the ultimate influencers of projects, not only landscape restoration, but in other areas as well. The dynamics in donor funding and NGO work have made it a requirement for projects to be sustainable. This has necessitated the acquiring of information from target communities through needs assessment exercises. NGOs fear that initiating projects while excluding views of communities is tantamount to implementing projects that have unsustainable impact as they would lack community ownership and relevance. One NGO official adds,

“The greatest influence is on the persisting problem that the community is facing, because if the project is not necessary for the community, then the community might not support it and therefore there will not be sustainability of the specific project.”

Premised on the assumption that communities are in better position to know problems they face and how to solve them, the powers to decide on projects has tended to fall on the community members. Whether this strategy is the best for sustainability and maximized impact is beyond the scope of this study. However, such strategies may have contributed to the invisibility of the NFLS even at national and district levels making it difficult to affirm that restoration interventions by NGOs align with the NFLRS.

There is visible coordination and collaboration among stakeholders working in the same catchment area

Responses across key informants confirm a strong collaboration among central government, local government, NGOs and communities. Essentially, government acts as a policy holder and regulator, local council helps in designs and implementation, while the community ensures sustainability. This affirms the power asymmetric between development partners (donors), NGOs and the government, [and the communities]. The collaboration transcends mere regulator-implementer relationship. It manifests long term working relationship for sustainable development. This collaboration is more observed at the local government level. In some instances, as stated by an official at CADECOM, local councils support with manpower such as providing NGOs with Engineers from district councils to help on irrigation projects implemented by NGOs.

At national level, this strong collaboration is sustained by a member-based platform called the National Restoration Platform; a platform formed in 2021 with its secretariat housed in the Ministry of Natural Resources, Environment and Climate Change, to mobilize resources, plan and implement actions and monitor progress. Its membership includes government departments, civil society organizations, private sector and community-based organizations (Karch, et al, 2023). As observed by (Karch, et al, 2023), despite inconsistent policy guidelines, inadequate resources and some elements of coordination challenges in landscape restoration, platform members in Malawi see concrete benefits and impact from the multi-stakeholder collaboration. The landscape restoration work therefore positively interacts with the SDG 16 by promoting partnerships and multi-stakeholder collaboration.

Monitoring on FLR lies on periodic country-wide survey and district plans

The NFLRS lacks clarity on who is responsible to lead monitoring of restoration progress apart from acknowledging the role of development partners in actively supporting restoration and that development partners are “well-positioned to assist with participatory monitoring and other forms of data collection for robust FLR monitoring system”.

Apart from reliance on NGOs, government at different levels has banked on periodic nation-wide studies that are conducted under the Ministry of Finance, Economic Planning and Development. Preliminary reviews ahead of developing indicators and metrics for monitoring the progress of implementing interventions in FLR found that many of the core indicators and metrics that had been proposed for monitoring the progress on FLR are already being regularly collected through the National Statistical

Office's Integrated Household Survey (IHS) (GoM, 2017); a survey that aims to monitor household conditions of Malawians. IHS is normally conducted at the interval of 6 years. The latest IHS results were released around 2020. Also the long-term nature of restoration projects has made monitoring expensive. For a country that depends on development partners to fund most of its projects, monitoring of restoration projects has become almost unreliable.

At district level, NGOs relies on the District Development Plans (DDPs) and District Socio-Economic Profile. DDPs carry the plans and aspirations of the entire district, with precise needs of areas covering the district. Since DDPs are developed from the grassroots through Village Action Plans, it is presumed that addressing the gaps in DDPs is synonymous to addressing the gaps in NFLS. However, with the revelation of low awareness on the NFLS among both NGO and government officials, it would be a hasty generalization to conclude that interventions in implementing interventions in DDPs translates into implementing interventions in NFLS. The linkage has to be made clear so that it is also easy for the country to report on the AFR100.

Recommendations

The study identifies misalignment among policies/legal instruments which has both accelerated and decelerated restoration effort, finds that fear of project sustainability has amplified community voice in selecting restoration interventions, that there is visible coordination and collaboration among stakeholders working in the same catchment area, and lastly that monitoring on FLR lies on periodic country-wide survey and district plans. The paper brings forward the following recommendations:

1. Government together with its stakeholders should move to harmonize environmental laws and policies for effective response to deforestation and destruction of forest resources.
2. For effective alignment of NFLRS and restoration interventions at community level, NGOs should intensify community awareness effort on NFLRS considering that communities are the ultimate deciders of projects implemented at local level. If communities are conversant with the Strategy, they may easily consider aligning their projects to the Strategy while contributing to attainment of landscape restoration and multiple SDGs.
3. Government should come up with deliberate policies to promote availability of alternative sources of energy in both rural and urban areas. This could be done by subsidizing gas, solar energy equipment and electrical equipment. This would minimize pressure on firewood and charcoal. Relatively, there should be a proliferation of stations for refilling cooking gas even in rural areas, moving from the current state where people move long distances to find gas stations, getting discouraged along the way.

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